



August 10, 2023

Clinical Case Quiz

A 43-year-old female, who went to the beach this morning, calls Get care now complaining of a painful sunburn. She denies any blisters and did not apply sunscreen.

The best treatment for a mild to moderate sunburn is:

- a. *Topical steroids*
- b. *Topical silver sulfadiazine*
- c. *Oral NSAIDs*
- d. *Cool compresses and soaks*
- e. *Two of these are correct*



Note. From Sunburn [Photograph] by Kelly S. DeConnick, 2006, Wikimedia Commons (https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Sunburn_%28131417495%29.jpg).

Oral NSAIDs and cool compresses are most effective in reducing pain from a mild to moderate sunburn. The use of topical steroids or silver sulfadiazine is not advised.

Best answer: e. Two of these are correct

This sunburn could have been prevented if she used sunscreen and followed which of the following guidance:

- a. *She used sunscreen with a sun protection factor of at least 30*
- b. *She applied sunscreen 15 to 30 minutes prior to sun exposure*
- c. *She reapplied sunscreen every two hours*
- d. *All of these are correct*
- e. *None of these are correct*

Preventing sunscreen involves using sunscreen with an SPF of at least 30 at least 15 to 30 minutes prior to going outside and reapplying it every two hours.

Best answer: d. All of these are correct